

Camilo Acosta

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Summary

Results-driven economist with over five years of experience in international development and academia, specializing in economic research, impact evaluation, and evidence-based decision making. Currently leading the development of Evidence Gap Maps and other initiatives at the Inter-American Development Bank to strengthen the integration of knowledge into operations and policy design. Ph.D. in Economic Analysis and Policy from the University of Toronto, with expertise in firms, trade, growth, and economic geography, and a strong publication record in top-tier journals.

Education

- 2014-2020 Ph.D. in Economic Analysis and Policy, Rotman School of Management, University of Toronto, Canada
- 2012-2013 M.A. in Economics, Universidad de los Andes, Bogotá, Colombia.
- 2008-2012 B.A. in Economics, Universidad de los Andes, Bogotá, Colombia.

Employment

- 2023- **Inter-American Development Bank (IDB)**, Washington, DC
Specialist, Knowledge and Learning Division
 - Lead the development of Evidence Gap Maps to support evidence-based decision making.
 - Compute knowledge indicators for the IDB Group's Impact Framework and the Knowledge Influence Index.
 - Support the monitoring and analysis of impact evaluations.
 - Conduct research on the role of project executing units to enhance project effectiveness.
 - Provide technical and analytical support to the Knowledge Advisory Committee.

Key Achievements:

 - Led the construction of the *Policing and Transportation* Evidence Gap Maps in collaboration with the Citizen Security and Transportation Divisions and 3ie.
 - Participated in the institutional reform of the Development Effectiveness Framework.
 - Member of two multi-departmental teams awarded R&D TCs under implementation in 2025.
 - Contributed to the Amazon Unit's Knowledge Agenda and Brazil's 2024-2027 Country Strategy.
 - Proposed and implemented two new indicators adopted in the IDB Group's Impact Framework.
- 2022-2023 **Aalborg University**, Copenhagen, Denmark.
External Research Fellow for the Project RESPOND, BUILD-Department of the Built Environment.
 - Designed two rounds of a national survey to study firm growth during COVID-19 in Denmark.
 - Publish a research article with the survey results.
- 2020-2023 **Universidad EAFIT**, Medellin, Colombia.
Assistant Professor, School of Finance, Economics and Government.
 - Co-lead three projects providing support to public policy interventions in Colombia: (i) the design of an impact evaluation for a housing improvement program, (ii) the socioeconomic valuation of an urban renewal program, and (iii) the economic analysis of a business formalization program.
 - Published peer-reviewed articles in top journals and started various other research projects.
 - Adviser for five undergraduate and five master's degree theses.

Publications

- “Spatial Wage Differentials, Geographic Frictions and the Organization of Labor within Firms,” with Ditte Håkonsson Lyngemark, 2025. *Regional Science and Urban Economics*. [\[LINK\]](#)
- “Resilience Strategies of Danish Firms in the Pandemic,” with Nino Javakhishvili-Larsen and Bence János Boje-Kovács, 2025. *Global Challenges and Regional Science*. [\[LINK\]](#)
- “Uncertainty and Immigrant Entrepreneurship: Evidence from Brexit,” with Astrid Marinoni, 2025. *Organization Science* [\[LINK\]](#)
- “Quality of Communications Infrastructure, Local Structural Transformation, and Inequality” with Luis Baldomero Quintana, 2024. *Journal of Economic Geography*. [\[LINK\]](#)
- “Access to Formal Financial Markets and Microbusiness Formalization in Colombia,” with Acevedo, A., & Angel, A. 2023. *Revista Coyuntura Económica de Fedesarrollo*. [\[LINK\]](#)
- “The Internal Spatial Organization of Firms: Evidence from Denmark,” with Ditte Håkonsson Lyngemark. 2021. *Journal of Urban Economics*. [\[LINK\]](#)
- “Un Enfoque Económico de la Detención Preventiva. Crecimiento de la Población Reclusa y Hacinamiento Carcelario en el Tránsito del Sistema Penal Acusatorio Colombiano (2003-2008).” (with Hernandez, N., & Zorro-Medina, A.) In E. Lozano -Rodríguez (Ed.), *Teoría y Puesta en Práctica del Análisis Económico del Derecho Colombiano* (pp. 251-282) Bogotá: Ediciones Uniandes, 2016.
- “Pobreza, Brechas y Ruralidad en Colombia,” with Parra-Peña, R.I., & Ordoñez, L. 2013. *Revista Coyuntura Económica de Fedesarrollo*. [\[LINK\]](#)

Evidence Gap Maps

- “Building Stronger Transport Policy: An Evidence Gap Map” Anda, M.D., Borja, L., Córdova-Aráuz, D., Engelbert, M., Porto, I., Rossetti, M., & Shisler, S. 2025. IDB & 3ie [\[LINK\]](#)
- “Informing Citizen Security Policy: An Evidence Gap Map on Policing Interventions” Britto Lima, S., Kang, M., Porto, I., Serrano Berthet, R., & Villalba, H. 2025. IDB [\[LINK\]](#)

IDB Publications

- “Evidence Gap Maps as a Tool for Evidence-Informed Decision-Making” with Kang, M., & Shisler, S. 2025. *IDB-LM-3231* [\[LINK\]](#)
- “Evidence Gap Maps: User Guide” with Porto, I., Rossetti, M., Anda, M.D., & Shisler, S. 2025. *IDB-LM-0770* [\[LINK\]](#)
- “Unveiling the IDB’s Project Executing Units: Performance Indicators, Results-Based Management, and Demand for Knowledge” with Cambra, G., Martínez-Carrasco, J., Cerda, M., Kang, M., Villalba, H., & Yepez, C. 2024. *IDB-TN-2961*. [\[LINK\]](#)

Work in Progress and Working Papers

- “On the Tension Between Due Process Protection and Public Safety: The Case of an Extensive Procedural Reform in Colombia,” with Angela Zorro-Medina and Daniel Mejía, 2023. *Revise and Resubmit - Journal of Law and Economics*. [\[LINK\]](#)
- “Superstar ZIP Codes,” with Fabian Eckert and Jack Liang, 2024. [\[LINK\]](#)
- “Are Free Trade Agreements being Used? Transaction Level Evidence for Colombia,” with Cindy Leal, 2023. [\[LINK\]](#)
- “The Incidence of Land Use Regulations.” Documento de Trabajo CIEF 21-04, 2021. [\[LINK\]](#)
- “Birth Rates, Factor Shares and Growth.” with Andrés Alvarez, Camilo Gomez and Hernando Zuleta. Documento CEDE 2019-20. [\[LINK\]](#)

Referee Service

Journal of Urban Economics, Regional Science and Urban Economics, Real Estate Economics, Journal of Regional Sciences, Scientific Reports, Journal of Economics and Management Strategy, Journal of Housing Economics,

IDB Working Paper Series, The Annals of Regional Sciences, European Journal of International Management, Desarrollo y Sociedad, Built Environment, Journal of Economic Structures.

Teaching Experience

- 2024-2025 Advanced Microeconomics (Invited Instructor); Graduate, Universidad EAFIT.
- 2020-2023 Advanced Microeconomics, Industrial Organization, Topics in Urban Economics; Graduate, Universidad EAFIT.
- 2020-2023 General Macroeconomics, Industrial Organization; Undergraduate, Universidad EAFIT.
- 2015-2019 Teaching Assistant, International Trade, Advanced Macroeconomics, Real Estate Economics, Real Estate Investment, Managerial Economics, Model-Based Decision Making; University of Toronto.

Other Research Experience

- 2016-2019 Research Assistant for Professors Nathaniel Baum-Snow, William Strange, Lu Han, and Mitchell Hoffman. University of Toronto.
- 2013-2014 Research Assistant for Professors Marcela Eslava, John Haltiwanger, Hernando Zuleta, and Hernán Vallejo. Universidad de los Andes, Bogotá, Colombia.

Conferences & Talks

- 2025 American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association Annual Meetings (Washington, D.C. - Discussant).
- 2024 American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association Annual Meetings (Washington, D.C.), Urban Economic Association Meetings (Washington, D.C.), Southern Economic Association Meetings (Washington, D.C.).
- 2023 University of North Texas, Universidad ICESI (Cali), American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association Online Seminar, 4th Urban and Regional Economics Workshop - U Javeriana & RSAI (Bogota), Transitional Entrepreneurship Colloquium (Virtual).
- 2022 American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association Annual Meetings (Washington, D.C.), Workshop on Strategy and Structure of Business Groups (CEPR - Milan), Congreso Anual de la Red de Investigadores de Economía (Cali).
- 2021 Banco de la República (Medellín), American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association Annual Meetings (Virtual), ICESI (Cali), Zoning Bylaw Renewal Team (Edmonton).
- 2020 ENSAE - CREST (Paris), Pontificia Universidad Javeriana (Bogota), Universidad EAFIT (Medellin), Online Urban Economics Seminar (Philadelphia FED), Virtual Urban Economic Association Meetings.
- 2019 Canadian Urban Economics Conference (Montreal), 2nd Urban and Regional Economics Workshop - U Javeriana (Bogota), University of Toronto.
- 2018 Canadian Economic Association Meetings (Montreal), Urban Economic Association Meetings (New York), Kraks Fond (Copenhagen).

PROGRAM COMMITTEE

Urban Economics Association Meetings, 2022; The Economics of Informality Conference, Universidad del Rosario, 2022; Latin American and Caribbean Economics Association (LACEA), 2021; 5th RES Symposium of Junior Researchers - Royal Economic Society, 2019.

Honors & Awards

- 2024 AI for Growth (Technical Cooperation), Inter-American Development Bank.
- 2024 Development Effectiveness Intelligence Fund (Technical Cooperation), Inter-American Development Bank.
- 2020-2022 Internal Research Funding, Universidad EAFIT.
- 2020 Hartle Award (for outstanding graduate scholarship on a policy-relevant topic), Rotman School of Management, University of Toronto.
- 2019-2020 University of Toronto Fellowship (UTF).
- 2014-2019 PhD Fellowship, Rotman School of Management, University of Toronto.
- 2016-2019 Myron J. Gordon Fellowship. Rotman School of Management, University of Toronto.

2017 CRESSE Fellowship in Competition Policy.
2008-2013 “The Best Students”, SAB Miller - Bavaria S.A, Bogotá, Colombia.

Other Relevant Courses

Business Opportunities and Applications of Generative AI - Stanford University, Online - 2024.
Summer School on Competition Policy and Regulation - CRESSE - 2017.

Languages and Software

Spanish (native), English (fluent), Portuguese (advanced), German (intermediate), French (beginner).
Stata, GIS, Python